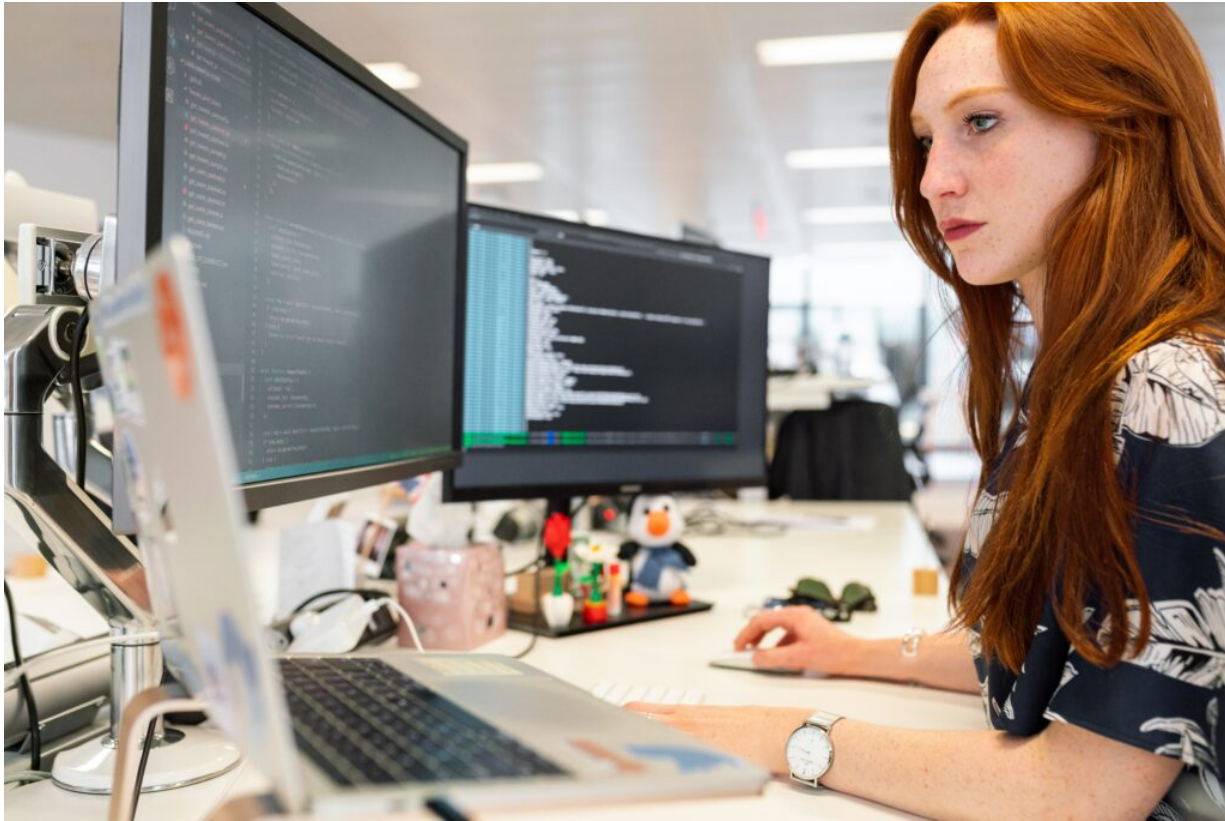


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I4. The Licence Professionnelle

As noted above, BTS and DUT graduates can pursue further studies toward a degree qualification in a number of ways, depending on their vocational programme and institution or school. One option available to graduates of both vocational streams is the **Licence professionnelle**, or “professional bachelor’s degree”. The professional licence is a national diploma of level bac + 3 (i.e., level 6 of the national directory of professional certifications) and is best understood as an applied degree.

First established in 2000, the Licence professionnelle enables students who have completed two years of postsecondary education via a BTS or DUT programme to earn a career-oriented bachelor’s-level degree with one year of additional study. The Licence professionnelle programmes are based on partnerships involving universities and other institutions of higher learning, businesses and professional groups.



Aside from their applied focus on technical and other career skills, the defining features of the degree are professional internships and the prominent instructional role of practicing professionals. Because they are widely recognized in the job market as one of the best ways for students to prepare for a career, they also boast a very high job placement rate (93%) for graduates.

This area of higher education has expanded considerably in the past decade. Since 2015 Licence professionnelle degrees in 173 different areas have been created for occupations in every field, including agricultural and industrial production, service sector commerce and administration, transportation and personal and corporate services.

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